

Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for guitar and voice. It consists of four staves of music, each with a corresponding line of lyrics. Above each staff, guitar chords are indicated with their names and fingerings. The key signature is D-flat major (two flats), and the time signature is 3/4. The lyrics are arranged in three lines, with the first line of lyrics corresponding to the first staff, the second line to the second staff, and the third line to the third staff. The fourth staff contains the final line of lyrics. The chords are: D-flat major (1 1 1 4), E-flat minor (3 4 2 1), A-flat major (4 1 3 2), D-flat major (1 1 1 4), D-flat major (1 1 1 4), G-flat major (3 1 2 1), A-flat major (1 3 4 4), A-flat major (4 1 3 2), D-flat major (1 1 1 4), G-flat major (3 1 2 1), E-flat minor (3 4 2 1), F major (2 1), D-flat/F major (x x x), F minor (1 2 4), E-flat minor (3 4 2 1), A-flat major (4 1 3 2), and D-flat major (1 1 1 4).

1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,
3 And since to look at things in bloom

hung with bloom a - long the bough,
tween - ty will not come a - gain.
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,

it stands a - bout the wood - land ride
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,

wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.
see the cher - ry hung with snow.